



BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE
Pilani Campus
AUGS/ AGSR Division

First Semester 2026-2027

Course Handout (Part II)

Date: 30/07/2026

In addition to Part-I (General Handout for all courses appended to the Timetable), this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course Number : GS F322

Course Title : Critical Analysis of Literature and Cinema

Instructor In-Charge : PRATEEK

[Team of Instructors] : N/A

1. Course description:

Creativity and Aesthetics; Overview of Approaches to Literature, Interpretation of Selected Works; Cinema; Understanding Drama: Theme, Character, Plot, Form; Understanding Fiction: Setting, Point of View, Plot and Character; Understanding Short Fiction and Novel: Meaning and Message, Style and Coherence; Understanding Comics; Understanding Cinema: Relationship of Form and Meaning, Image Construction, Shots, Scenes, Sequences, Mise-en-Scene, Codes, Frames, Signs, Syntax; Sound: Diegetic & Non-diegetic Sound, Silence; Linear and Non-linear Narrative Structure.

2. Scope and Objective:

The course attempts to inculcate in students a critical insight required to interpret a work of literature or cinema. To enable the students to imbibe such perception and critical judgment, the subtle nuances of such works will be taught extensively. Students will also be introduced to different forms, terminologies and trends prevalent in such artistic ventures to enable them to place a work of art in the proper context.

3. Course learning outcomes:

- a. Have basic concepts of literary and artistic productions;
- b. Identify various genres of films and literature;
- c. Understand, analyze various art forms, keeping in mind recent trends and theoretical underpinnings;
- d. Apply acquired knowledge in real life scenarios.

4. Text books and references:

TB-1. Muller, M. Gilbert and John A. Williams, *The McGraw-Hill Introduction to Literature*, 2nd Ed., New York: McGraw Hill Inc., 1995.

TB-2. Monaco, James, *How to Read a Film*, New York: Oxford University Press, 2000.

RB-1. Abrams, M.H., *A Glossary of Literary Terms*, Noida: Harcourt, 2000 (7th Edition).

RB-2. Macdonald, Dwight, *Dwight Macdonald on Movies*, New Jersey: Prentice-Hall, 1969.

RB-3. Robinson, David, *The History of World Cinema*, New York: Stein and Day Publishers, 1973.

RB-4. Scott, Wilbur, *Five Approaches of Literary Criticism*, New York; The Macmillan Company, 1962.

5. [Method of conduct of the course]: Lectures

6. Course Plan

Week No	Module No.	Lecture Session	Reference to	Learning Outcome
1-2	1-4	Function, Process and Trends in Various Art Forms; Contextual Framework for Literature and Cinema	Class Notes, TB-1 (or text provided in the class), RB-1 pp. 224-228; 231-236; 260-262	Understanding the basic concepts of narration and background of works of art, such as a short story. Identifying different genres of short story with its ten commandments. Engagement with the first story of the course
2-3	5-8	Short Fiction: Meaning, Message, Style, Coherence, Theme, Symbolism, Imagery	Class Notes or TB-1 (or text provided in the class), RB-1 pp. 275-278	Satire and its types (Western and Indian counterparts); Engagement with the second story of the course
3	9	Writing Workshop	Class Notes	Learning how to write an answer for the course
4	10-12	Poem: Meaning and Style	Class Notes or TB-1 (or text provided in the class)	Satire in Indian poetry; Characteristics of Indian English writing style; Engagement with Indian poetry
5-6	13-18	Cinema as an Art Form: Historical Overview; Basic Concepts of Film Medium, Relationship of Structure, Meaning, Feeling, Image Construction; Film Aesthetics: Form, Mise-en-scene, Image, Tone, Magnitude, Colour, Contrast, Continuity; Language and Grammar of Cinema: Codes, Frames, Montage, Sound, Silence, Different Shots, Signs, Syntax.	TB-2 (Chapter 2), class notes	Identifying cinema as an art form; understanding its various components and how they tell the "story"; ability to analyse films based on the acquired knowledge; examples will be discussed and demonstrated in the class. Engagement with the movie/s of the course.
7-8	19-24	Introduction to Drama/Gameplay: Theme, Dialogues, Character, Plot and Language	To be provided, class notes	Ability to understand the genre and its salient features or analyzing the work of art through myriad perspectives



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Week No	Module No.	Lecture Session	Reference to	Learning Outcome
9-10	25-28	Critical approaches to literature: Sociological, Psychological, Archetypal and Formalistic Approaches	RB-4 pp. 11-22; 23-57; 123 161; 69-98; 247-315; 179-231, RB-1 pp. 236-263. class notes	Understanding and applying various theories to analyse works of art.
10-11	29-33	Important Aspects of a Novel: Setting, Point of view, Tone, Style, Meaning, Structure, etc.	RB-1 pp. 190-196, class notes	Understanding the genre; how it differs from other forms of fiction; characteristic features; analyzing a piece of work
12	34-35	Comics	To be announced in class, class notes	Understanding comics as a medium of dissemination of ideas; identifying and analysing such works of art as children's literature.
12-13 -14	36-40	Individual Films	To be announced in class, class notes	Analyzing "not-so-mainstream" movies and identifying their story-telling technique; applying the critical acumen discussed in modules 19-24.
14	41-42	Summing up		

7. Evaluation Scheme:

Component	Duration	Weightage (%)	Date & Time	Remarks
Class Assignment (1)	45 mins	15	-to be announced-	CB
Assignment 2	50 mins	20	-to be announced-	CB
Mid-Sem Test	90 mins	30	-As per the AUGSD schedule-	OB

Comprehensive	3 hours	35	-As per the AUGSD schedule-	OB
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Criterion for NC: As per the AUGSD guidelines

8. Chamber consultation hours: 2 pm to 3 pm (Thursday).

9. Makeup Policy: As per the AUGSD guidelines

10. Attendance Policy: Students are required to attend and participate in classes.

Prateek
Instructor In-charge
GS F322